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Loaning Money? Call It a Gift

**If you want to know what a dollar is worth,
try to borrow one.**

Chances are that throughout your life people have asked to borrow money from you. Think back to grammar school, did any of your friends ever forget their lunch money? What about when you went out to eat with friends, were they ever short on cash? Did anyone ever have their credit card declined because they were up to the limit and you had to step in? As you got older and had more money to lend, did anyone ever ask for help making his or her rent payment or ask you to cosign on a loan?

If you did decide to loan your money for any of these reasons, did you get it back? Did you lend the money because you wished to help or because you were made to feel guilty? Did it cause friction in the relationship? Did lending money put you into financial difficulty if it was not repaid?

Giving to others has long been one of the enduring religious and moral teachings. U.S. giving has represented about 2 percent of gross domestic product for four decades, according to the Center on Philanthropy at Indiana University. And young adults are among these charitable givers. Barna